

Module 3 - Modern Meta Methodology

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Introduction

Welcome to Module 3 - Creating Winning Ads.

In this module we are going to take a deep dive into the modern way of running Meta ads.

Whether you're brand new to Meta Ads or you've run campaigns before, this module will show you the approach you should be taking to consistently get results in the current Meta ecosystem.

We'll move away from outdated ideas around heavy **targeting** and focus on what really matters now.

Creative, messaging, and how the **algorithm** responds to your ads.

By the end of this module, you'll understand how to think about ad creation, testing, and iteration in a way that aligns with how Meta delivers ads today and not outdated methods you've likely seen or learnt before.

Modern Meta

In this video we're going to talk about how Meta Ads actually work today and why the biggest driver of performance is no longer **targeting**, but **creative**.

A lot of advertisers still approach Meta the way it worked years ago, focusing heavily on interests, audiences, and complex **targeting** setups.

The reality is that Meta has changed.

Due to privacy updates, data restrictions, and the scale Meta now operates at, the platform relies far more on its **algorithm** to decide who sees your ads.

Instead of you telling Meta exactly who to target, Meta now learns who responds to your ads by analysing how people interact with your **creative**.

This means your ads themselves play the biggest role in determining performance.

Creative Targeting

To understand the way Meta operates today we first need to understand where it came from and how it has developed.

In the past Meta relied heavily on audience **targeting** to decide who should see your ads.

Media buyers would build campaigns with multiple ad sets, each one **targeting** a different interest, demographic, or lookalike audience.

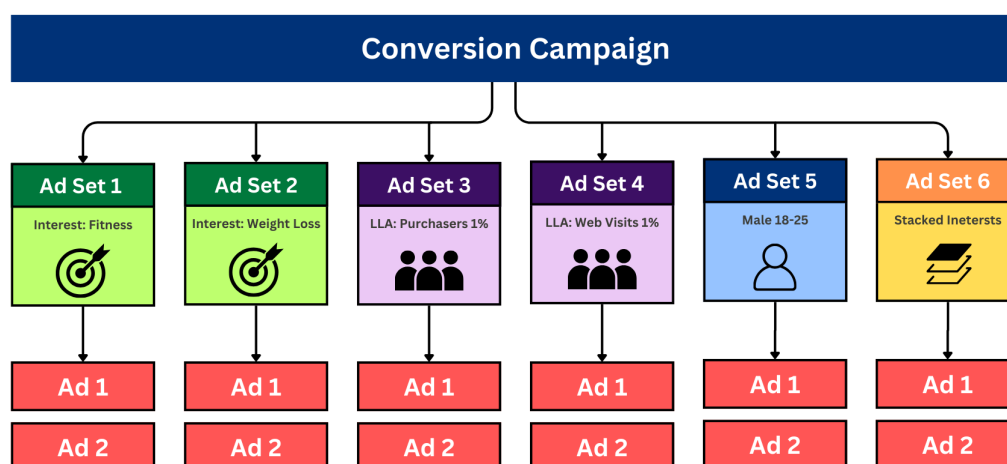
The goal was to find small pockets of people who were likely to convert by narrowing **targeting** as much as possible.

Most of the testing happened at the ad set level and not the **creative** level.

The same ads were often duplicated across multiple ad sets, with the only variable being the audience.

If performance was poor, the assumption was that the **targeting** was wrong, not the ad.

This approach worked when Meta had access to far more user-level data and **targeting signals**.



This structure also came with many downsides.

- Slow learning due to fragmented audiences
- Budget spread thin across many ad sets
- Limited **creative** testing
- Heavy manual optimisation

As privacy changes reduced the effectiveness of interest and demographic **targeting**, this structure became less reliable.

Meta could no longer depend on narrow audience definitions to drive performance.

Because of this Meta had to come up with a new way to drive ad performance so that it could still offer a reliable service to advertisers.

Instead of **targeting** people directly, Meta started learning who to show ads to based on how people responded to the **creative** itself.

Creative is now the primary driver of Meta ad performance.

What Do We Mean By Creative

Creative is a term you will hear a lot when it comes to ads and it's really important we clarify what we actually mean by this.

It's not just the visual elements of an ad and how it looks and there are a number of components that make an ad **creative**.

Creative is the full message being communicated to the person seeing the ad.

Meta doesn't just analyse whether someone watched a video or clicked an image.

It analyses how people respond to the idea being presented.

Your **creative** is going to be made up of several elements working together.

- **The hook**

The first line, opening frame, or visual that stops the scroll.

- **The angle**

The perspective you're taking on the problem, desire, or opportunity.
Different angles attract different types of people.

- **The message**

What you're actually saying. The story, explanation, or promise being made.

- **The framing**

How the message is positioned. This could be educational, direct, emotional, logical, aspirational, or problem-focused.

- **The format**

Video, static image, UGC, talking head, screen recording, text-led, carousel.
Different formats create different engagement patterns. In this module we will cover how to create winning ads across both video and static formats, including how to write copy and structure messaging for each.

- **The call to action**

What you're asking someone to do next and how clearly that's communicated.

These are all elements that influence how people interact with your ad.



We can have two ads that look really similar, but if the hook, angle or framing changes they can perform completely differently.

This is why Meta can deliver these ads to completely different people.

We're not just showing people different visuals to see what gets people taking action.

The **algorithm** is reacting to behaviour triggered by the different messaging.

Understanding this is critical.

Because when you change the **creative**, you're not just changing how the ad looks. You're changing who the **algorithm** learns to show it to.

How Meta Uses Creative Signals to Find Buyers Today 🧠

Meta's ad delivery system is built to constantly learn and adjust based on how people respond to your **creative**.

At a high level, Meta looks at ad performance and uses those **signals** to decide who should see your ads next.

Every interaction sends information back to the system.

This includes:

- How quickly someone stops scrolling
- How long they watch a video
- Whether they engage with the ad
- Whether they click
- Whether they convert

Meta is constantly looking at these **signals** and looking for patterns or user behaviour.

If people respond well it can then increase delivery of that ad to similar users. Or, if people don't respond well it can reduce delivery.

This is constantly happening in the background and is the system Meta now uses to drive all ad performance.

You will likely have heard this referred to as 'andromeda'.

Meta does not optimise around interests or demographics in the same way it used to.

It optimises around how people respond to ads.



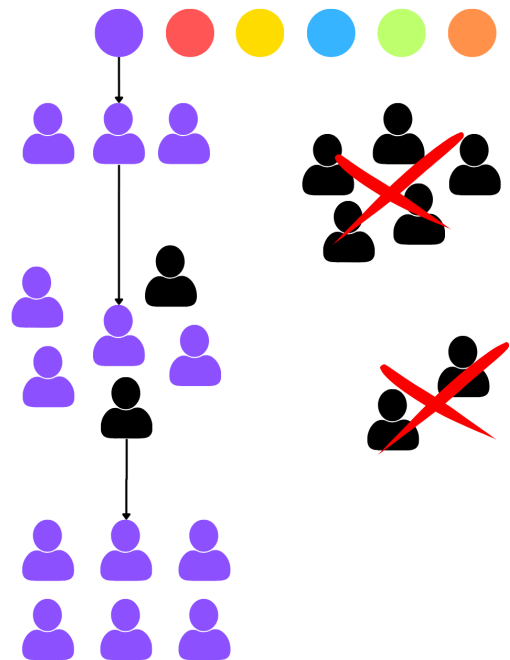
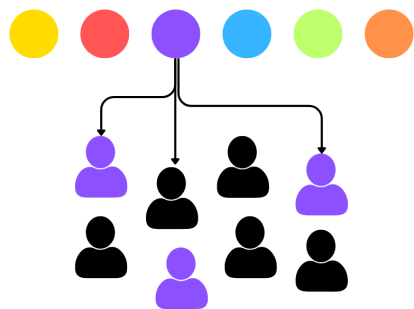
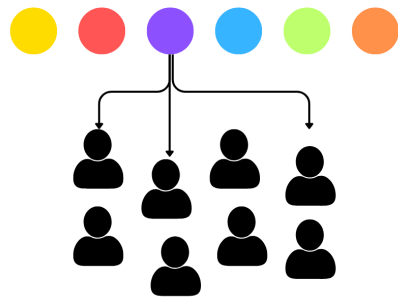
- Your ad is the input.
- User behaviour is the **signal**.
- The **algorithm** is the decision-maker.

This is why two ads in the same campaign can attract completely different types of people, even when **targeting** is identical.

For example, one ad might attract people who respond to social proof and authority, while another attracts people who respond to speed and simplicity.

Even with identical **targeting**, Meta will learn these patterns and deliver each ad to different subsets of users.

The **creative** itself determines who the **algorithm** finds.



Creative fatigue, messaging shifts, and angle testing matter more than ever.

When performance drops, it's usually because the **creative signals** have weakened, not because the **targeting** is wrong.

Creative fatigue isn't just people getting bored. It's the point where the **signals** your ad sends become weaker, causing Meta to reduce delivery.

Understanding this changes how you approach testing, scaling, and optimisation.

And it's the foundation for everything else we're going to cover in this module.

AI Driven targeting

Meta has been gradually bringing in new AI tools into its system for a while now.

This includes things like:

- Adv+ campaigns
- Ad level AI tools
- AI bid adjustments

These tools have all been designed with Meta new ways of learning in mind.

Each one gives the **algorithm** more freedom to find different pools of people and learn about where your ads will perform best.

When you heavily restrict **targeting**, you limit the number of people Meta can test your ads against.

This slows learning and makes it harder for the **algorithm** to find patterns.

Broad audiences allow Meta to observe how different types of people respond to your **creative** and quickly adjust delivery based on real behaviour.

Instead of pre-filtering people with interests or demographics, you let the **algorithm** do the filtering for you.

Your ad is the filter.

If your ad and **creative** is strong you will naturally attract the right audience and repel the wrong one.

When **targeting** is too narrow:

- Meta has less data to work with
- Learning takes longer
- Performance becomes unstable

- Scaling becomes harder

When **targeting** is broader:

- Meta can test faster
- Patterns emerge more clearly
- Winning **creatives** are identified sooner
- Scaling is smoother

However, we can still use some **targeting** elements when they are relevant.

For instance we might need to exclude certain age ranges if we are selling a product or service that isn't suitable.

Think of your audience **targeting** as who can see your ad.

Think of your **creative** determining who will see the ad.

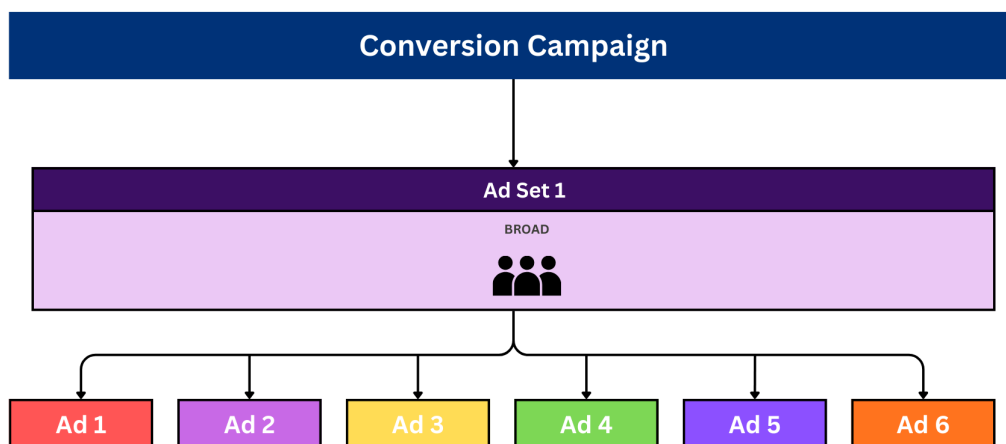
You can use audiences as guardrails

Your **creative** is the lever.

Your key to success with Meta is now going to be around:

- Volume
- Variation
- Testing

New Account Structure



Account structure is now focused around:

- Fewer adsets
- Broader **targeting**
- More **creative** variations
- Testing takes place at ad level not audience level.

What's Next

Now that you understand why **creative** drives performance on Meta, you have the foundation for everything else in this module. **Creative** is the input. Behaviour is the **signal**. The **algorithm** is the decision-maker. Every lesson from here builds on that.

In the next video we are going to break down ad angles. You will learn what an angle is, why different angles attract different people, and how to use them as the strategic foundation for all your **creative** testing.

You'll learn how to think about angles, how to structure **creative** testing around them, and why testing angles is far more effective than testing audiences.

This is going to be the core of your **creative** strategy.

Everything we've covered in this video sets the foundation for how you'll approach ad creation, testing, and iteration moving forward.